

# Epilogue

My association with the industrialist did not last long. Non-interfering at first, he slowly began to get demanding. He did not quite like it when I refused to kowtow to his wishes. When a couple of trades went rather badly, our relations soured further.

Towards the end of 2014, we parted ways as amicably as we could. My bank balance swelled some more, but I was beginning to get disillusioned with the stock market. Close friends advised me to reinvent myself as a venture capitalist and look for potential winners in start-ups. My previous experience with start-ups had been disappointing. But the landscape had changed considerably and I did not mind trying my hand at it.

I began to take a deeper interest in my farm at Murbad and I am now also working with a non-profit organization when not meeting budding entrepreneurs. I cannot help my gut feeling that the financial markets – particularly the stock market – are so disconnected from the real world. The non-profit organization I support runs a skills training centre, and counsels and provides shelter for girls and women who have suffered abuse and violence. It was a humbling experience for me when, during a talk on the importance of saving money, a girl, perhaps eighteen, told me that she had made it a point to save at least Rs 50 every week, and hoped to own a place of her own some day.

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I dropped by GB's office one day when I was passing that way. More than nine months had passed since my last stock market trade. I found GB in a dark mood, though he was trying his best not to let it show.

We exchanged pleasantries and reminisced about the good old times. I asked him about some of the big guns of the market, remarking that they